

shots. If you have a high bandwidth available then the software used these days will scale your image quality upwards accordingly to give you the best visual performance so don't worry about getting a low resolution camera just because your internet speed is low, even video compression has come a far way.

Frame rate – The downside of having a high resolution is that a high amount of data needs to be processed every second, this slows down the frame rate. So even if you are going in for a high resolution webcam, unless it has the processing power to back it up and get you a decent 30 frames per second frame rate your video feed will seem like a stop motion animation sequence. So ensure that the camera you'd want can deliver high frame rate at the mentioned quality.

Autofocus – All webcams come with autofocus, however, the implementation differs from manufacturer to manufacturer. Different algorithms decide what to ignore and what to focus on though we don't see any way of figuring that out by just looking at the product box, only reviews can do any help here.

Inbuilt mic – Webcams do sometimes have an inbuilt mic so you can do away with a separate microphone. Though the distance at which the mic can pick up sound, i.e. the mic gain does matter, so it'd be wiser to invest in a separate microphone.

Grip – This is an important aspect to webcams, a flexible grip that can be modified to affix to any surface is necessary, also having a heavier base helps. If the base isn't heavy enough then fiddling with a webcam becomes quite the nuisance. We have webcams coming with claw grips, gorilla grips and the simple flat metal base, so you can take your pick.

Lens – The difference between having a plastic lens and a glass lens in front of the webcam is that plastic tends to get scratched much easily as compared to glass, so even frequent wiping to clean the lens may inadvertently fog up the lens in the long run and ruin your webcam.

Flash / Lighting

Webcams have sensors built in to detect low light conditions and subsequently switch on LED lights to illuminate the subject. Webcams and mobile phone cameras are known to function poorly in low light conditions, so having this feature is a big plus. The cameras that can double up as a motion sensor do tend to have infra red LEDs so you can be assured of a good coverage even at night.